

Aijia Zhang

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Research Interest

Corporate finance, Corporate governance, Institutional investors, and Textual analysis.

Education

University of Glasgow **10/2022–Present**
PhD in Finance Programme
Current Stage: Thesis Pending *Glasgow, UK*

University of Glasgow **01/2021–03/2022**
Master of Science in Management with International Finance with Distinction
○ **Weighted Average Mark:** 18/22 (A) *Glasgow, UK*

Beijing Normal - Hong Kong Baptist University
United International College (UIC) **09/2016–06/2020**
Bachelor of Business Administration (Honours) in Applied Economics
○ **GPA:** 3.30/4.00 (Second Class Division One) *Zhuhai, China*

Research Project

PhD Thesis **10/2022 - Present**
○ **Foreign Institutional Investors and Underperforming CEOs: Evidence from Chinese Listed Firms**
In this paper, we examine the potential mechanisms through which foreign institutional investors force out underperforming CEOs.

○ **Foreign Institutional Investors' Site Visits and Tunnelling**
This study investigates whether and how foreign institutional investors' (FIIs) site visits affect tunnelling through inter-corporate loans.

○ **Investor-firm interactions and corporate innovation: Evidence from China**
This study uses the Easy Interaction platform and the E-interaction platform to examine how the interactions between investors and firms affect corporate innovation.

Summer School **07/2023**
○ **Difference-in-Differences with Panel Data** Barcelona, Spain
Study on how to apply the Difference-in-Differences (DiD) method with panel data to estimate causal effects, ensuring the validity of the parallel trends assumption and using fixed effects models to control for unobserved heterogeneity.

Bachelor Dissertation
○ **The impact of Big Explosion on Average Wages in Different Industries** **12/2019-04/2020**
This study examines the impact of a major explosion in China on average wages across different industries. Using the difference-in-difference (DID) method, I analyze how this exogenous shock influences China's labour market.

Conference Presentations

2026: Asian Finance Association (AsianFA) Annual Meeting	Seoul, South Korea
2026: European Financial Management Association (EFMA) Annual Meeting (accepted; not attended)	Kristiansand, Norway
2025: Financial Management Association (FMA) Annual Meeting	Vancouver, Canada
2025: Financial Management Association (FMA) European Conference	Limassol, Cyprus
2025: European Financial Management Association (EFMA) Annual Meeting	Athens, Greece
2025: Chinese Economic Association (CEA) Annual Conference	Glasgow, UK

Work Experience

University of Glasgow 01/2025-Present

Organizer of Internal Seminars for Finance PhDs

- In internal seminars, PhD students in finance present their research topics and receive feedback. As the organizer, I also invite faculty members to discuss their research papers or share insights on the job market experience.

University of Glasgow 10/2023-Present

Graduate Teaching Assistant (GTA)

- Course: Foundations of International Corporate Finance.
Explain key concepts in international corporate finance, including agency conflicts, mergers and acquisitions, and the time value of money. Provide guidance on effectively reading and interpreting corporate finance literature.

Tianjin Tongguang Group Special Equipment Co., Ltd. 06/2019-08/2019

Intern, Accounting Department

Tianjin, China

- Audited financial documents and financial procedures;
- Compiled and presented reports, budgets, business plans, commentaries and financial statements;
- Administered payrolls and controlled income and expenditure;
- In charge of analysing accounts and business plans.

Industrial Bank Tianjin Branch 06/2017-08/2017

Lobby Manager(Intern), Retail Division

Tianjin, China

- Oversaw provision of a full range of services to customers and prospective customers, and guaranteed that customers were promptly and professionally served;
- Identified customers' needs, customized financial plans to assist clients in reaching their financial goals accordingly;
- Wrote unbiased performance assessment for bank tellers, and gave appropriate appraisals to encourage co-workers and boost their morale.

Awards

CFA Level I Pass	2020
First Class Excellent Academic Scholarship	2019/2020
Second Class Excellent Academic Scholarship	2018/2019
Recognized Student Specialized in Dancing	2015/2016

Skills

Technical: Python, Matlab, Stata, EVIEWS, SPSS, Bloomberg, LaTeX and all Microsoft-based software

Languages: English (Fluent), Korean (Intermediate)